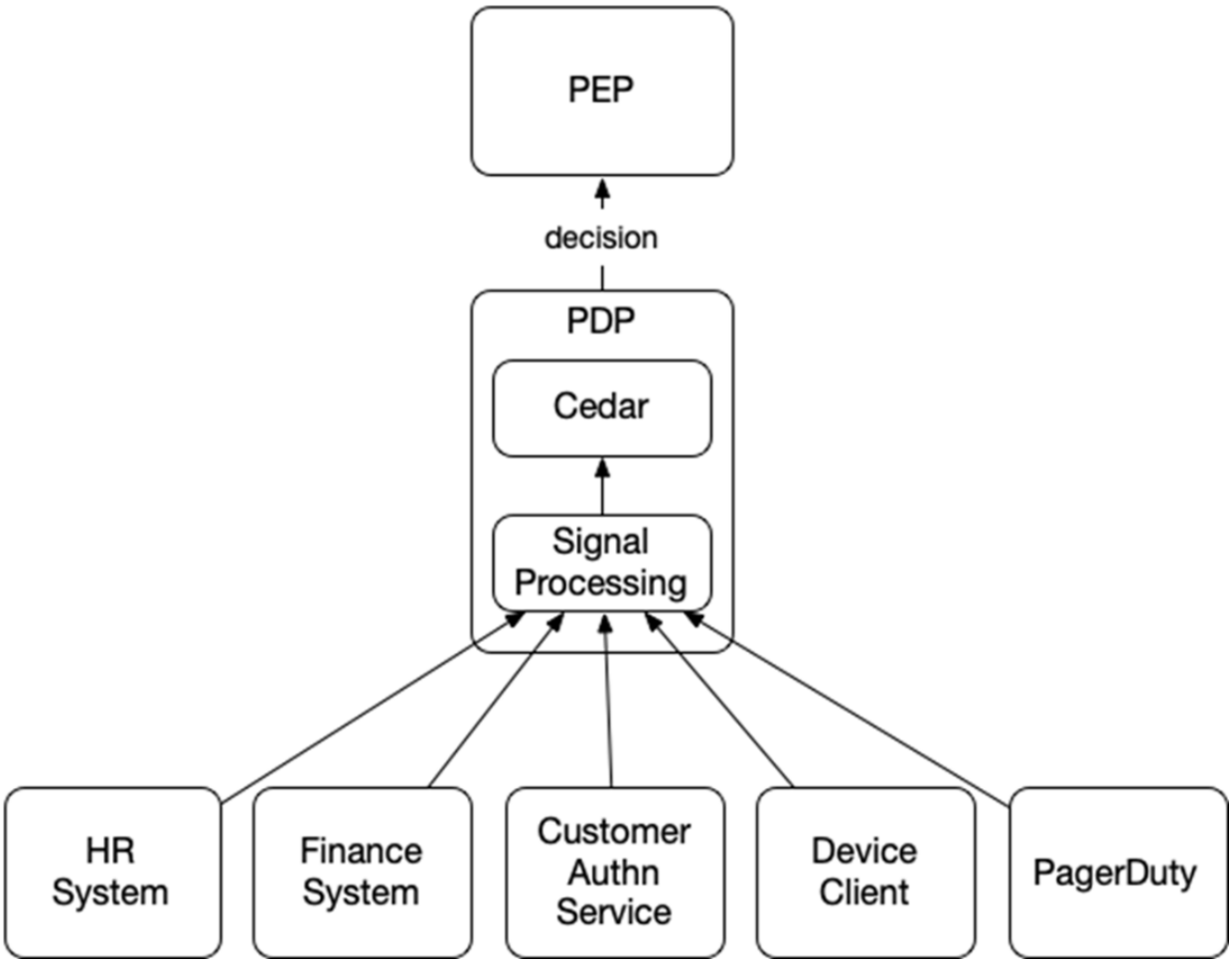


Figure 12.2 Inside the Policy Decision Point. The PDP includes more than just a policy engine. At ACME, a signal-processing layer collects data from various systems—HR, Finance, the Customer Authentication Service, device posture clients, and external services like PagerDuty—and organizes it into well-formed entities for evaluation by the Cedar engine. The PDP then provides a decision to the PEP after policies are assessed against the collected context.

At ACME, this logic originally grew independently within each platform. The Customer Collaboration platform used its own entity model for customers and employees, while the engineering deployment tool defined a different schema optimized for operational use. Each PDP wrapped the Cedar evaluator with custom code that translated data from internal systems, device posture, and external service calls into its own entity structure. The approach worked, but it required maintaining multiple, inconsistent models and writing separate policies for each system.

These inconsistencies caused friction. A policy that depended on `resource.owner` in the collaboration platform might use `resource.createdBy` in the deployment tool. Employees who switched